

Course Outline

Course Title- Approaches to Globalization

Course Code- HM 467

Semester- Winter

Category- Open Elective

Instructors- Prof. Madhumita Mazumdar

Course Objectives

This course will introduce students to the economic social and cultural phenomena of globalization. Based on the understanding of the implicit relationship of productive processes to society and history, the course will present to students a series of cases, mainly drawn from Asia to understand the multiple sites and forms of globalization.

Unit One will introduce students to the concepts, definitions and historical origins of the processes of globalization in the 20th century.

Unit two will focus on the complex travel of information, goods, technologies, ideologies and people around the world – and how these are apprehended and negotiated by people in specific locations.

Unit three will draw attention to the argument that while globalisation is a formidable force for change, there are also equally formidable factors that resist it.

Unit four will Globalisation will introduce students to debates on migration, technology, media and the environment.

Students will have the opportunity to investigate a relevant topic of the choice and apply social-scientific explanatory frameworks in a final paper.

Course Outcomes

The intensive reading and analysis that the course expects from students, is to make them critically engage with issues of social and economic “change” they see around them. At the end of the course they will be expected to develop a deeper understanding of specific questions pertaining to globalization and social change. Is change always a desired and set goal? Does it follow any standardized or uniform agenda? Is globalization an innate drive towards socio-cultural homogenization ? Or does globalization invariably lead to cultural and social fragmentation? And finally what is the defining role of communication technology in both driving the processes of globalization and generating resistance to it?

Course Structure

A sequence of themed lectures will cover some essential ideas that the course intends to impart to you. Related to the lectures will be readings

that would help you to understand the basic ideas. The lectures are not to simplify the readings but to approach the readings with a degree of critical attention- particularly the ones that are portioned as discussion readings. Consequently each unit of study will have a lecture or two and set of case studies. Student groups would develop presentations based on the readings and research conducted at both the individual and group level.

Course Topics to be considered

UNIT 1. INTRODUCTION; MAKING SENSE OF GLOBALIZATION

UNIT 2. CAPITALISM AND NEOLIBERALISM

Unit 3. HISTORICAL AND ANTHROPOLOGICAL FRAMEWORKS

UNIT 4. THE ANTECEDENTS OF GLOBALIZATION-

COLONIALISM AND

IMPERIALISM

UNIT 5. THE REVOLUTION IN COMMUNICATION

TECHNOLOGIES

UNIT 6. TRANSNATIONALISM AND HUMAN FLOWS

UNIT 7. THE GLOBAL FLOWS OF CULTURE AS PLEASURE AND

AS PRODUCT

UNIT 8.COSMOPOLITANISM AND LOCALISM: CULTURE AND RESISTANCE

UNIT 9. AGAINST GLOBALIZATION

UNIT10. GLOBALIZATION- FROM “BUZZWORD TO CURSE”

Course Evaluation : Active and informed participation in the class will count as 10% of the final grade. An end- semester exam would count for 50% of the final grade and a group research project based on the themes and readings presented will constitute 40% of the final grade.

Select Readings

Appadurai.A, Modernity at Large: Cultural Dimensions of Globalisation

Appadurai A (ed). Globalisation, Durham, NC: Duke University Press.

Bauman, Zygmunt. Globalization: the human consequences. Cambridge: Polity Press, 1998.

Beck, U. Risk society. London: Sage, 1992.

Castells, Manuel. The informational city. Oxford: Blackwell, 1989.

Castells, Manuel. The rise of the network society, Vol. I. Massachusetts: Blackwell, 2000.

Hannerz, Ulf. The global ecumene as a network of networks. In A. Kuper (ed.), *Conceptualizing society*. London: Routledge, 1992.

Hannerz, Ulf. *Transnational connections*. London: Routledge, 1996.

Harvey, D. *The condition of postmodernity*. Oxford: Blackwell, 1989.

Herman, Edward S. and Robert W. McChesney. *The global media*. New Delhi: Madhyam Books, 1997..

Jameson, Fredric. Globalization and political strategy. 'New Left Review' 4: July-August 2000: 49-68.

Sassen, S. *The global city*. Princeton, NJ: Princeton University Press, 1991.